Lenny Bronner

Data Scientist

lenny.bronner@gmail.com New York City, NY

Relevant experience

2024 – Staff Applied Machine Learning Engineer The Washington Post

Architecting data science solutions for personalization, including push notifications and recirculation modules used across product teams.

Architected, built, and deployed a production multi-armed bandit system (classic, contextual, and combinatorial) with live serving and real-time reward feedback, increasing recirculation click-through rate by 30%.

Maintaining and evolving elections data infrastructure used across newsroom and product teams.

2022 –2024 Data Science Lead, Newsroom Engineering The Washington Post

Owned the development of The Post's 2024 Presidential polling average, spanning national and swing state models, resulting in The Post's most popular story page in three years and millions of pageviews.

Led the team that re-designed the live election night model for the 2024 Presidential election using modern statistical methods. This resulted in The Post's first aggregate presidential forecast and significantly improved the stability of state forecasts.

Oversaw a rebuild of The Post's voter registration data pipeline. This added flexibility to how data was stored and also decreased load time by 60%.

Oversaw the development of a voterflow model, which estimates how different groups voted. This was used in multiple stories during the 2024 primaries.

2019 –2022 Senior & Principal Data Scientist, Newsroom Engineering The Washington Post

Built and deployed The Post's first live election night model, used during the 2020 Presidential election to forecast state outcomes under real-time reporting constraints.

Appeared on The Post's live election coverage to explain model insights to viewers.

Designed pipelines and tools to collect and analyze live election results, voter registration information and campaign finance data.

Designed models using voter registration data, including estimating vote choice for the 2020 Presidential election.

Implemented data pipelines that contributed to reporting on the Jan. 6 insurrection at the U.S. Capitol that won the 2022 Pulitzer Prize for Public Service.

2017 –2019 Data Scientist, Big Data & Personalization The Washington Post

Built and deployed a metadata tagging engine for The Washington Post, which is used in ad targeting and recommender systems.

Designed the Counterpoint model, a system that shows readers the opposite political view of the opinion they are currently reading.

Led development of a document search tool for the newsroom that combines different data sources including: bills & laws, White House press pool reports and congressional statements.

2014 –2017 Data Science Fellow, Sidewire

Built a deep neural network to identify the most informative paragraph in news articles

Education

2016 –2017 | M.Sc in Statistics, Stanford University
GPA: 3.73/4.0

2012 –2016 | B.Sc in Mathematical and Computational Science, Stanford University
GPA: 3.73/4.0

Selected writing

2024 | How The Washington Post's forecast will track 2024 election results

2022 | How The Washington Post reports election race calls
(with Scott Clement)

2020 | How The Washington Post Estimates Outstanding Votes for the 2020 Election
(with John Cherian)

2020 | Generating Location-Based News Leads for National Politics Reporting
(with Nicholas Diakopoulos, Madison Dong and Jeremy Bowers)

2019 | How The Washington Post Estimates Turnout on Election Night

More writing can be found on my The Washington Post author page.

Selected talks and conferences

2025 | Should I believe those crosstabs? Cross-validating pre-election polls, post-election polls and geographic voting patterns
at AAPOR (with Scott Clement)

2024 | Election Forecasting at The Washington Post
at Scientific Discovery in the Age of Data & AI at Stanford University

2024 | Election Forecasting at The Washington Post
at CSTE Infectious Disease Forecasting & Modeling Workshop

2022 | Automated Text-Based Classification of Political Campaign Expenses
at Computation + Journalism (with Dylan Freedman)

2022 | Parsing Federal Election Committee filings quickly
at NICAR (with Dylan Freedman)

2021 | Predicting Elections using Live Data at The Washington Post
at Computation + Journalism

Skills

Modeling | Election modeling, online learning & bandits, personalization, conformal inference

Engineering | Python, SQL, Java, AWS, production ML systems

Tools | Git, Jupyter, LaTeX

Languages | English, German